Rita Santos

Senior / Staff Tech Lead (Distributed Systems) | Distributed Systems & Backend Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer and Tech Lead specializing in high-throughput distributed systems, event-driven architectures, and resilient backend microservices using Go, Python, and Apache Kafka. Proven track record of leading platform re-architecture, mentoring engineering teams, and scaling cloud-native infrastructure on AWS.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer / Tech Lead 2021-Present
CloudScale · Porto, Portugal

- Leading system architecture for high-throughput, low-latency event-driven backend services and API platforms.
- Re-architecting monolithic services into microservices using Go, Python, and Apache Kafka.
- Mentoring engineers on code quality, Domain-Driven Design (DDD) principles, CQRS patterns, and technical design.
- Managing AWS cloud infrastructure and containerized deployments using Docker, Kubernetes, and Terraform with observability via Datadog and OpenTelemetry.

Senior Backend Engineer 2018-2020
FinTech Global · Porto, Portugal

- Developing REST and gRPC microservices in Go and Python.
- PostgreSQL database schema design, query optimization, and transaction boundary management.

Software Engineer 2015-2018
InnoTech Labs · Porto, Portugal

- Developed and maintained core backend services and APIs.
- Participated in database optimization and deployment pipelines.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. in Informatics Engineering (Mestrado Integrado em Engenharia Informática) 2010-2015
FEUP · Porto, Portugal · 17/20

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Programming Languages: Go, Python, SQL, Bash

Architecture & Systems: Distributed Systems, Microservices, Event-Driven Architectures, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, PostgreSQL, Redis, Domain-Driven Design (DDD), CQRS

Cloud & Tools: AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Git, OpenTelemetry, Datadog

LANGUAGES

Portuguese: Native (Native language) · None

English: C2 Proficient (Proficient professional level) · None

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